Proliferation Treaty. The treaty forbade states from receiving, manufacturing, or seeking assistance in the manufacture of nuclear weapons or nuclear explosive devices.[32]

The NPT attracted a large number of signatories; by 2000, 187 states had acceded to the treaty. This included countries that were seriously considering the development of a nuclear weapons capacity but chose to abandon their ambitions and sign the NPT,[33] as well as states that had already developed nuclear weapons capabilities and decided to dismantle them in order to join the treaty.[34]

India and Pakistan, however, were among a small group of states that insisted on retaining their right to develop nuclear weapons and refused to sign the NPT. The two countries began actively pursuing nuclear programs soon after achieving independence. Despite Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru's public opposition to nuclear weapons, the Indian government established a Department of Atomic Research in 1954. India's crushing defeat in the 1962 Sino-Indian War, China's 1964 nuclear test, Chinese threats to intervene in the 1965 Indo-Pakistani War, and the existing nuclear powers' refusal to grant India a security guarantee, ultimately led the Indians to abandon their antinuclear posture. The Indians refused to sign the Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty, and they tested a nuclear device soon thereafter, achieving a fifteen-kiloton peaceful nuclear explosion (PNE) on May 18, 1974.[35]

Pakistan established its Atomic Energy Commission in 1957. Pakistani efforts initially focused on the production of civilian nuclear power. However, Pakistan's nuclear programs took on a military bent after the mid-1960s. Following the stalemated 1965 Indo-Pakistani war, the United States cut off arms transfers to Pakistan, and India began to achieve conventional superiority. Faced with this eroding military position, the Pakistanis refused to sign the Nuclear Non-Proliferation Treaty. Pakistan embarked on a full-fledged nuclear weapons program in 1972 after its devastating loss to India in the Bangladesh war.[36]

India and Pakistan's refusal to join the NPT and foreclose the possibility of acquiring nuclear weapons was not based solely on strategic calculations. Their position was also rooted in history. The